

IMPOSSIBLE POOLS DIVIDENDS

Uwezike Obi

Port Harcourt

It was the defunct Federal Nigerian Government that banned Overseas Footballs Pools under the pretext that it wanted to conserve its economy. But stakers who had no say but to obey the law, knew that some politicians had explored another avenue to make money.

Their kith and kin were directors of the Niger Pools and received commission amounting to thousands monthly. Niger Pools tried to be honest or at least fair with stakers.

On the achievement of Independence by Biafra, many Football Pools Companies were licensed to operate. Some of these Football Pools Companies cannot be said to make honesty or fairplay their strongest point.

They declare whatever they like as the first dividend no matter the position of the draws or the number of draws.

For an example, for matches played

on 13th January, 1968, there were only six draws. Experienced forecasters know that to score 22 points was near impossible but our pools companies have declared first dividend on 22 points.

I challenge these companies to publish the full names and addresses of the first dividend winners and to continue to do so every Wednesday. This is the only way to convince stakers that they are not all out to cheat and exploit. Failing to do this, our Government should see to it that:

Weekly collections minus expenses should be made known to the Government.